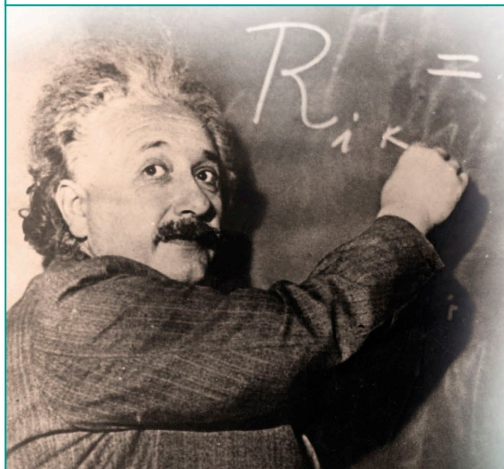


Einsteinium

99
Es



In 1952, a new kind of powerful nuclear weapon called the hydrogen bomb (H-bomb) was tested. After the explosion, scientists studying the debris found around 200 atoms of a new actinide. They named this new element after the German-American physicist Albert Einstein.

ATOMIC MASS (252)

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1952–5 (team led by Albert Ghiorso)

Albert Einstein

Curium

96
Cm

The actinide curium was named after the Polish-French scientist Marie Curie and her husband, the French scientist Pierre Curie – the discoverers of the element radium. Rovers (remote-controlled robot vehicles used for exploration) on Mars use curium to shine X-rays on rock samples, revealing what is in them.

ATOMIC MASS (247)

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1944 (team led by Glenn T Seaborg)

**Marie Curie in
her laboratory**

Californium

98
Cf

This element was named after California, the US state where it was first made. Californium is a raw material used for making very heavy elements, such as oganesson. It is one of the world's most expensive substances: a gram of californium costs US\$27 million. This is because it is difficult to produce this highly radioactive element, making it rare.

ATOMIC MASS (251)

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1950 (Stanley Thompson, Kenneth Street Jr, Albert Ghiorso, and Glenn T Seaborg)
